Why did I say what I said to Raman, who continued to be a very good friend even after our retirement, though we never discussed this issue again? Why and how was Bhindranwale's support enlisted by a select group of Congress party leaders for Op-1? How did Op-1 get converted to Op-2? Why were Bhindranwale and his men used to encourage extremism, leading to a Hindu-Sikh divide in Punjab? How did the concept of Khalistan gain credibility amongst the Sikh diaspora in the West from 1981 onwards?

What was the final solution to the Punjab/Khalistan problem that the 1 Akbar Road group wanted? Was it to ensure maximum impact on their potential voters in the next general elections? Why was the hope of a negotiated settlement with moderate Akali Dal leaders kept dangling till the very end of May 1984, a few days before Operation Blue Star was launched? Why was R.N Kao recalled from retirement, and how did the R&AW, for which Sikh extremism and Khalistan were non-issues till the end of 1979, suddenly get involved in related activities from the end of 1980? Why were other comparatively less harmful solutions to capture Bhindranwale from the Golden Temple complex overruled?

All this, as well as my own experiences in the days following Operation Blue Star – during and after the November 1984 anti-Sikh pogrom in Delhi and other cities of India – has been narrated in this book in as dispassionate a manner as possible. This book is a painful revelation of a high-level conspiracy that resulted in the death of thousands of innocent persons and created a gigantic problem out of a hitherto non-existent issue – that of Khalistan.